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OCTOBER 7, 2026

Educators are trying to shape AI before AI shapes school

The week's strongest signal is a shift from reaction to design: universities, districts, and vendors are building test beds, procurement rules, and teacher-first tools before classroom AI hardens into defaults.

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Penn GSE launches a living laboratory for human agency and AI

The University of Pennsylvania Graduate School of Education launched the Living Laboratory for Human Agency and AI, a network connecting researchers, educators, school systems, and industry partners to test AI in real educational settings. The initiative focuses on human agency, trust, safety, practice-driven innovation, AI literacy, and infrastructure for scale, according to [Newswise](#).

That framing captures the new phase of AI in education. The question is no longer whether schools will encounter AI, but whether educators can generate evidence, norms, and design patterns before general-purpose tools define classroom practice for them.

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The next frontier is not just adopting AI responsibly. It is giving educators enough evidence and design power to shape what responsible AI becomes.

The evidence agenda is moving into live settings

Living labs replace abstract AI predictions

Penn GSE's new hub will test AI tutoring tools, educator resources, literacy strategies, and governance approaches in authentic school partnerships. [Newswise](#).

Procurement is becoming an evidence problem

Districts are trying to judge whether AI products are safe, explainable, privacy-preserving, bias-aware, and actually improving learning before they buy. [Education Week](#).

Teacher demand is specific: AI built for education

Sanoma's 2026 European Teacher Survey found 75% to 93% of teachers want AI tools designed for education rather than adapted from general-purpose applications. [Yahoo Finance](#).

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Nordic focus

Nordic publishers and schools lean teacher-first

🇫🇮 FINLAND Helsinki-based Sanoma Learning launched Sanna, an AI teacher assistant trialing in Finland, Sweden, and other European markets, built on local learning materials and national curricula. [Yahoo Finance](#).

🇳🇴 NORWAY Norway's rapid school AI uptake remains a cautionary benchmark, with earlier reporting showing tools used in nearly three-fourths of primary/lower-secondary schools and over 90% of upper-secondary schools. [VG](#).

🇳🇴 NORWAY Bodo's participation in the European AI Academy project keeps Norway focused on curriculum, teacher networks, and responsible use rather than tool access alone. [NRK](#).

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Around the globe

Around the world, AI readiness is being structured

 **US** New York City is keeping student-facing generative AI out through eighth grade while requiring high-school AI literacy modules and allowing selected supervised pilots. [International Business Times Singapore](#).

 **KENYA** UNESCO and Codemao's youth coding initiative has trained more than 1,200 Kenyan students and established school coding clubs in 20 schools. [Xinhua](#).

 **VIETNAM** Vietnam's national AI education framework will give every grade 12 core periods per year, with schools choosing modules, subject integration, or elective activities. [Vietnamnet](#).

 **INDIA** The Millennium AI Creators Championship named student winners in storytelling, song creation, and short film challenges around sustainable cities and responsible AI. [LatestLY](#).

 **UAE** Alef Education is showcasing responsible, AI-powered learning at Ai Everything Abu Dhabi 2026, pairing personalization claims with safety and trust language. [Emirates News Agency on MSN](#).

 **US** EDUCAUSE 2026 closed with AI reportedly topping higher education's 2027 IT issues list for the first time. [Tech Times on MSN](#).

Teacher control is becoming the product promise

Sanna puts local curriculum inside the assistant

Sanoma's teacher assistant supports lesson planning, assignments, feedback, differentiated materials, and presentations while requiring teacher review before classroom use.

[Yahoo Finance](#)

Districts are writing harder AI buying tests

Procurement checklists now ask who controls data, whether student data trains models, whether outputs can be explained, and whether the tool solves a real instructional need.

[Education Week](#)

Living labs make product testing a research activity

Penn GSE's model treats AI tools as hypotheses to test with educators and students, not products to drop into classrooms after the fact.

[Newswise](#)

What to watch next

The rise of school-based AI test beds

Expect more universities and districts to build living labs that test tools before adoption.

Teacher-first AI becomes a market category

Vendors will increasingly claim alignment with curriculum, privacy law, and teacher judgment.

Policy moves from bans to age bands

New York's model points toward more differentiated rules by grade, purpose, and supervision level.

AI in Education Digest · Berit Herstad · October 7, 2026 · Compiled from public sources

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